

LEAN, MEAN NETBOOKS

Do you find a laptop overpowered, heavy and overpriced, for you need it just for email, Web access and basic computing on the move? Try a netbook, it will let you be lean and mean while traveling!

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Are you a first-time buyer looking for a low-cost device for basic computing applications? Or a professional looking for something that is lighter than notebook and lets you access the Internet and seek info on the move? To cater to your needs, a new category of device has emerged in the form of netbooks. Also called mini notebooks, sub-notebooks or ultra-portables, these devices look pretty similar to your office diary and are ideal for Web access, e-mail and light work on the go.

You may ask when PDA phones also serve the same purpose, what's the point in buying a netbook. But, accessing the Internet on a netbook is very different from that on a PDA phone. Majority of the content on the Internet is designed for computers. When you try to access it on a mobile, much is

not accessible. And many of the interactive features are lost out, as these are designed for a standard form factor and software.

In India, HCL and ASUS were the first to launch netbooks early in 2008 and therefore enjoy the first-mover advantage in this segment. With Intel introducing its Atom-based processor, it only adds to the growth. The market

is also abuzz with netbooks from Lenovo, Acer, Hewlett Packard and Samsung. Before you pick one for yourself, you need to know some basics. Here's the way to go.

How is a netbook different from a notebook?

You can't replace a notebook with a netbook. Notebooks are full-featured PCs that can perform computing-intensive, sometimes complex, and graphics-intensive tasks, and support longer hours of computing. Netbooks are simple, Internet-centric devices that rather act as a secondary PC with bare minimum hardware. With these, you experience mobile computing at affordable prices. Sup-



ported computing applications include document (proposals, letters) preparation, calculations (in spreadsheets) and presentations.

In terms of battery backup netbooks have an edge over notebooks, while in functionality notebooks are preferable owing to their faster processing speeds.

There are many other factors which differ in both the products, such as the absence of an optical drive in netbooks. While notebooks are available in screen sizes ranging from 25.9 to 43.2 cm (10.2 to 17 inches) and weigh 1.25 kg to 3 kg, netbooks are available in much smaller screen sizes of 17.8-25.9 cm (7-10.2 inches) and weigh only a little more than a kg.

Netbooks Vs Notebooks

Netbooks	Notebooks
Internet companion devices with screen sizes of 17.8-25.9 cm (7-10.2 inches)	Full-featured PCs with screens starting at 25.9 cm (10.2 inches)
Smaller keyboards	Full-size keyboards
Compact, lightweight and great battery life for traveling light and purpose-built for the Internet	Full PC experience with the flexibility of mobility
Get up-to-date news, the latest scores and weather information, access e-mail and social networking sites, and enjoy digital videos, photos and music	Multitasking, high-performance and richer Internet experience; play 3D games, HD, create videos, edit photos, burn CDs and DVDs; office on the go for maximum productivity
Source: Intel	